

It's pretty difficult to tell by visual inspection if slot CPUs are seated properly. When in doubt, reseal the CPU, which is fairly easy since the heat sink and the CPU are an integrated unit. Also, make sure that you correctly identify release levers located on the top of the slot CPU package.

3. There's no power to the heat sink fan

If the heat sink has a fan, it should be hooked to the correct power source on the motherboard for the BIOS to monitor and control its state. Be careful! If you have installed a new CPU and switched it on without the fan it may have failed already! Hopefully, you will be lucky and get away with it by hooking up the fan. It may also be that the power point on the motherboard is failing.

4. The jumper settings may have been incorrectly set if you are experimenting with overclocking or have installed a new motherboard Return the motherboard to its default settings. Use the motherboard manual to get the default values.

5. The cabinet or uneven fixing of the motherboard may be causing a short. Put the motherboard on a cardboard box covered with foam or a static free bag and hook it up. If the PC boots normally then the problem is most likely related to the cabinet or the fixing of the motherboard. Mechanical stresses on a bent motherboard might be leaving a circuit open and preventing it from working. Fix the motherboard properly in the cabinet and if the problem re-occurs change the cabinet.

Note: If there is a crack on the motherboard, you are in serious trouble! The motherboard is a printed circuit board and hence a crack will break the circuitry. You will in all probability have to buy a new motherboard.

1.4.2 The PC runs POST and then freezes

1. This may be a problem with the RAM modules or other add-on cards. In case of RAM module problems, you will usually be alert-